Scott Oatley
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Areas of Specialisation

Social Class, Social Stratification, Educational Inequalities, Youth Transitions, Health, Ageing, Ethnicity, Quantitative Methods, Longitudinal Data Analysis, Research Transparency and Reproducibility, Research Design, Social Theory.

EDUCATION

2021 – 2025 ***PhD Sociology*** **—** *University of Edinburgh*
ERSC Funded – Viva Passed with minor corrections 19th May 2025
Thesis Title: Youth in Transition: Longitudinal Comparisons of Youth Transitions in the UK using Cohort and Synthetic Cohort Data
Supervisors: Professor Vernon Gayle and Dr Roxanne Connelly.

2020 – 2021 ***MSc Sociology*** **—** *University of Oxford*
Thesis Title: Mobility and Consequences: How does social class mobility affect life satisfaction in the UK?
Supervisor: Prof Colin Mills

2017 – 2020 ***BSc Sociology*** **—** *London School of Economics* – Upper Second Class Honours

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Academic and Professional Employment

04/26- ***Research Fellow*** **–** *University College London, Centre for education policy and equalising opportunities*

04/25-05/26 ***Research Associate (ELSA)*** – *University of Manchester*

01/24-04/24 ***Research Assistant*** **–** *Data wrangling, descriptive statistics, and analysis using the Wealth and Assets Survey in R* – University of Edinburgh, *Department of Sociology*. Link to project here.

09/22-06/23 ***Research Assistant*** **-** *Recreating the BBC Class Calculator using open science principles* **–** University of Edinburgh, *Department of Sociology* – Link to project code here and project home page here.

Teaching Experience

Guest Lectures

10/23 & 10/22 **Guest Lecture –** *Research Skills in the Social Sciences: Data Collection (PGSP11016)* – University of Edinburgh, *Constructing Surveys and Questionnaire Design (~60 students).*

Undergraduate Level

2025, SEM2 Course admin/Marker **—** *Multi-level Modelling in Social Science (SSPS10024)* **—** University of Edinburgh*, (Course coordinator: Prof Lindsay Paterson)*

2025, SEM2 Tutor **—** *Introduction to Political Data Analysis (PLIT08009)* **—** University of Edinburgh *~20 students per lab, (Course coordinator: Dr Joe Greenwood-Hau)*

2024, SEM1 Seminar Lead — *Mathematics for Social Science* (*SSPS0809)* — University of Edinburgh *~40 students per lab, two labs taken (Course coordinator: Prof Lindsay Paterson).*

2022-2025, SEM2 Senior Tutor — *Doing Survey Research* (*SCIL10063)* — University of Edinburgh *~20 students per lab, two labs taken (Course coordinator: Dr Kevin Ralston).*

2023, SEM1 Tutor **—** *Sociology 1A: The Sociological Imagination (SCIL08004)* **—** University of Edinburgh *~10 students per seminar, four classes taken (Course coordinator: Dr Lisa Mccormick)*

Postgraduate Level

2022, SEM2 Senior Tutor **—** *Longitudinal Data Analysis* (*PGSP11487)* **—** University of Edinburgh, *~10 students per class, two classes taken (Course coordinator: Prof Vernon Gayle)*

Marking experience on several undergraduate and postgraduate courses across social theory, research design, and social statistics modules at the University of Edinburgh: Empires (SCAN08010), History of Western Medicine (STIS08009), Intimate Relations (SCIL10023), and Multi-level Modelling in Social Science (PGSP11424).

Other Teaching Experience
Training taught

10/04/25 **SGSSS Student Led Training Initiative** — **Handling Missing Data**. ESRC funded via the Scottish Graduate School of Social Science to design and deliver a short course on the construction and development of Handling Missing Data Methods in Stata and R. (~40 attendance).

20/10/24 SGSSS Student Led Training Initiative — Survey and Questionnaire Construction Using the Shiny Package in R. ESRC funded via the Scottish Graduate School of Social Science to design and deliver a short course on the construction and development of survey based web applications using the Shiny package in R. (~20 attendance).

20/09/23 SGSSS Student Led Training Initiative — Jupyter Notebooks: Improving Workflow for Social Science Research. Funded by the ESRC Scottish Graduate School of Social Science to design and deliver a short course on how to install, setup, and add additional extensions to a Jupyter environment to aid in promoting open scientific practices (~20 attendance).

Academic Services

Reviewer: *Methodological Innovations, Sociological Perspectives*
Member: *Society for Longitudinal and Lifecourse Studies, Large Social Surveys, BSA*

09/23- Founding member of Large Social Survey Group – A cross-Scotland research group that provides a platform for postgraduate students within the field of quantitative social science to come together, discuss ideas, and present research. I personally set up the LSSG online social media platform and website.

09/23- Leader of the Organising Committee for Large Social Survey Group Conference – *Leading member of the organising committee to set up an independent conference symposium for the members of the Large Social Survey Group to be held in May 2024.*

Publications

Submitted:

Oatley S, Kapadia D (2026) The adoption of a Capitals, Assets, and Resources-based (CAR) measurement of social class for the study of later life using the English Longitudinal Study of Ageing. osf.io/preprints/socarxiv/c7sra_v1. (submitted to Sociology)

Oatley S, Gayle V, Connelly R (2026) Staying on in Education: Longitudinal Comparisons of Young People's First Transition in Britain using Cohort and Synthetic Cohort Data. doi: 10.31235/osf.io/jkbtn_v1 (submitted to Youth Studies)

Oatley, S. (2026). 'socstrat: An automated command that constructs commonly employed social stratification measures'. *(Accepted and awaiting publication)*

Oatley, S. (2026). *'Measuring Social Class'*, in Sinharay, S. (ed.) Encyclopedia of Measurement in Social Sciences, Second Edition. Elsevier. *(Final Proofs on request)*

Oatley, S. and Costello, P. (2026). *'Measuring Educational Attainment'*, in Sinharay, S. (ed.) Encyclopedia of Measurement in Social Sciences, Second Edition. Elsevier. *(Final Proofs on request)*

Oatley S, Van Gunten T (2025) A new approach to teaching social class: Introducing the Edinburgh Open-Source Class Calculator. doi: 10.31235/osf.io/a37zp_v2. (submitted to British Journal of Sociology).

Working Papers:
Oatley S, Gayle V, Connelly R (2025) A Simulation Study Comparing Handling Missing Data Strategies. doi: 10.31235/osf.io/4vtqs_v1

Software Programs
socstrat – A stata command available on ssc. socstrat cleans, recodes, generates, and labels datasets to create variations of NS-SEC and RGSC based on SOC 1990, 2000, 2010, and 2020 codes. Available at Stata SSC.

Invited Speaker Engagements

05/02/25 **Transformative Change: Educational and Life Transitions** — *University of Dundee*. Invited to speak on the developments of educational and life transitional research.

Conference Presentations

23/04/26 **BJS Conference** — *LSE, "The adoption of a capitals, assets, and resources based measurement of social class for the study of later life using the English Longitudinal Study of Ageing" (accepted to present)*

16/04/26 **British and Irish Longitudinal Studies of Ageing Group Meeting** — *Institute of Fiscal Studies, "Age at Death: A Re-analysis of ethnic death statistics in the UK using ELSA linked NHS data" (accepted to present)*

10/04/26 **BSA Annual Conference** — *75 Years of Sociology, "Weberian social status reimagined: a sociological and empirical critique of existing measures and a viable alternative" (accepted to present)*

29/09/25 **Edinburgh Q-Step Centre Research Seminar** — *University of Edinburgh, ''A viable measure to assess stratification at later life''.*

23/06/25 **Stirling All Hands Seminar** — *University of Stirling, ''A re-examination of social status operationalisation: comparing established measures of status with an MDSCAL and factor analysis based approach''.*

20/05/25 **Large Social Survey Symposium** — *University of Edinburgh, ''Is there really a pot of gold at the end of the rainbow: an investigation of sexual orientation pay gaps in the UK''.*

10/04/25 **Intersectional analysis and quantitative methods** — *University of Loughborough, ''Gender Performance Scale as a Quantitative insight into Intracategorical Intersectionality''***.**

28/11/24 **Large Social Survey Seminar** — *University of Edinburgh, ''A re-examination of social status operationalisation: comparing established measures of status with an MDSCAL and factor analysis based approach''***.**

01/08/24 **Social Stratification Research Seminar** — *University of Stirling, ''Youth in Transition: Longitudinal Comparisons of Youth Transitions in the UK using Cohort and Synthetic Cohort Data''***.**

01/06/24 **Lead Round Table Panellist** — **ESRC National Centre for Research Methods Summer School: Large and Complex Social Survey** – *University of Edinburgh* – New Horizons: Round Table Lead by Early Career Researchers'.

10/05/24 **Large Social Survey Seminar** — *Stirling, 'A Simulation Comparing Handling Missing Data Methods'.*

15/04/24 **Inaugural British Journal of Sociology Conference 2024** — *LSE, ''Using Shiny as a teaching tool? Construction of the GBCS, NS-SEC, and Wright's Neo-Marxian schema as an open-source class calculator application''.*

19/02/24 **Edinburgh Q-Step Centre Research Seminar** — *University of Edinburgh, "*Youth Transitions and Economic Activity: A Re-examination of NCDS data".

30/08/23 **Social Stratification Research Seminar** — *University of Stirling, ''Using Shiny as a teaching tool? Construction of the GBCS, NS-SEC, and Wright's Neo-Marxian schema as an open-source class calculator application''***.**

18/05/23 **New Directions** — *University of Edinburgh, 'Re-examining the NCDS with contemporary statistical methods'.*

Key Skills

- R, Rstudio
- Shiny
- Stata
- SPSS
- Python
- Research Design
- SQL

References

Prof Vernon Gayle: Chair of Sociology and Social Statistics – Department of Sociology, University of Edinburgh

Dr Roxanne Connelly: Senior Lecturer of Sociology and Quantitative Methods – Department of Sociology, University of Edinburgh

Dr Dharmi Kapadia: Senior Lecturer of Sociology – University of Manchester